Notes version: 06 Nov 08:08 IST (if this time is old, reload the page)

HISTORY · Indus Valley Civilization

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? About 4,500 years ago, people in the plains of the Indus and its neighbouring rivers began to live in planned towns with brick houses, drains, standard weights and measures, and long-distance trade. This is India's first urban (city) civilization. 'Urban' means that not everyone is a farmer: some are traders, craftsmen and officials. That needs surplus food, so farming must be productive first. **Why does it matter for the exam?** It is the starting point of Indian history, and APPSC asks about its sites, town planning, crafts, trade, seals and decline every year.

1. Discovery, names and time

- **Discovery:** 1921, **Daya Ram Sahni** found Harappa (Montgomery district, now Pakistan); 1922, **R.D. Banerji** found Mohenjo-daro (Sindh). **John Marshall**, Director-General of the ASI, announced it in 1924. After Independence, **Ropar (Punjab)** was the first Harappan site excavated in India.
- **Names:** Harappan Civilization (after the first site found) and Indus Valley Civilization (because many sites lie on the Indus). Most sites actually lie along the dry Ghaggar–Hakra river, so scholars also use 'Indus–Sarasvati' or 'Sindhu–Sarasvati'; the exam usually says Indus Valley or Harappan.
- **Time (approximate):** Early Harappan c. 3300–2600 BCE; **Mature Harappan c. 2600–1900 BCE**; Late Harappan c. 1900–1300 BCE. The roots go back to farming villages such as **Mehrgarh** (Balochistan, Pakistan) c. 7000 BCE, where wheat, barley and cotton were already used. It is a **Bronze Age** culture: copper and bronze, no iron.
- **Extent:** about 1.25 million sq km, larger than Egypt and Mesopotamia put together. Limits to remember: **Sutkagen-dor** (west, near the Iran border), **Alamgirpur** (east, Uttar Pradesh), **Manda** (north, Jammu), **Daimabad** (south, Maharashtra).

2. The big idea: a planned town

Imagine a town built by a plan, not by chance. Streets met at **right angles** (a grid). Houses were built of **standard-size burnt bricks** (the ratio 1 : 2 : 4) around a courtyard; most had a bathroom and a well, and the doors opened to side lanes, not the main street. Waste water ran into **covered drains** with inspection holes along the street. The town had two parts: a raised **citadel** (west) for public buildings, and a **lower town** (east) where most people lived. Such care shows a strong civic authority. (Contrast: most later Indian towns grew without such planning.)

Site	Where	Why it is famous
Harappa	Punjab (Pakistan), River Ravi	First site found; granaries; workers' quarters; cemetery (R-37)

Mohenjo-daro	Sindh (Pakistan), Indus	**Great Bath**; best drainage; Priest-King bust; Dancing Girl; 'mound of the dead'
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)	Bead and bangle workshops; no citadel
Kalibangan	Rajasthan, Ghaggar	**Ploughed field** (criss-cross furrows); fire altars; 'black bangles'
Lothal	Gujarat, near the Bhogavo	**Dockyard** (port); bead-making; rice husk; trade with Mesopotamia
Dholavira	Gujarat (Kutch)	**Water-conservation** reservoirs; **three-part city**; large **signboard** with ten big signs; UNESCO site (2021)
Rakhigarhi	Haryana	Largest Harappan site in India
Banawali · Ropar · Alamgirpur	Haryana · Punjab · Uttar Pradesh	Banawali: barley, fire altars; Ropar: first post-1947 excavation; Alamgirpur: eastern limit
Daimabad	Maharashtra	Southern limit; bronze chariot, buffalo, elephant, rhinoceros (Late Harappan)

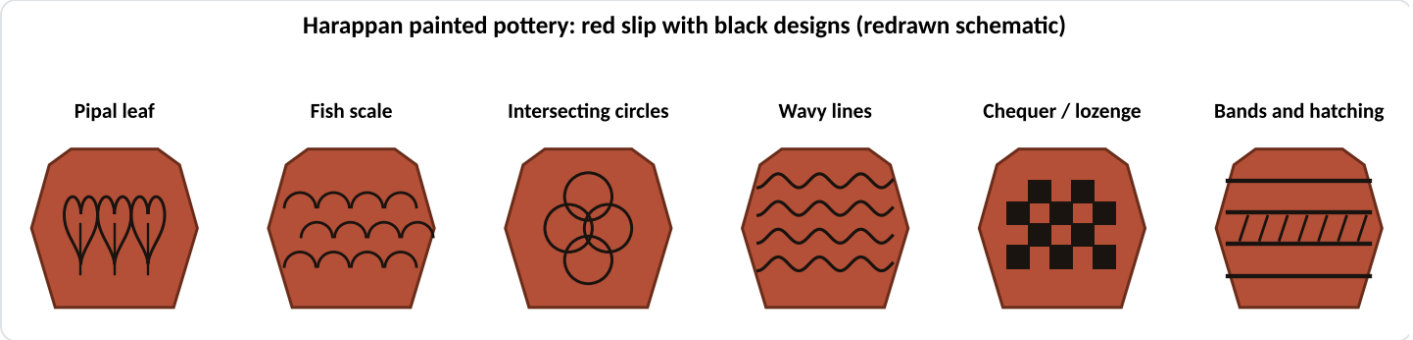
3. Farming, food and animals

Rivers flooded every year and left fertile silt, so farming gave a surplus without big canals. **Crops:** wheat and barley (main), peas, sesame, mustard, dates; **cotton** (among the earliest in the world); rice appears at **Lothal and Rangpur** (Gujarat) as husk. **Animals:** humped bull (zebu), buffalo, sheep, goat, pig, dog; camel bones and elephants are known; the horse is not clearly present. **Ploughed field** at Kalibangan proves ploughing. Stored grain was kept in granaries (Harappa, Lothal).

4. Crafts and art: pottery, seals, figurines, bronzes, beads

Harappans were skilled craftsmen. These are the items the exam asks about most:

- **Pottery:** made on the **potter's wheel** and baked in kilns. Most is **plain red ware**; the finer ware has a **red slip** with **black painted designs**: **pipal leaves, fish scales, intersecting circles, wavy lines, chequers, trees, birds and animals**. Special types: **perforated jars** (for straining or fermenting), pointed-base storage jars, goblets, S-shaped jars. Polychrome pottery is rare. Some pots carry signs scratched after firing (graffiti).
- **Seals:** about 2,000 found, mostly of **steatite** (soft stone), square, with an animal and a few signs. The commonest animal is the **'unicorn'** (one-horned bull); others are the humped bull, elephant, tiger, rhinoceros. Used to stamp trade goods and as identity marks; the **Pashupati seal** shows a horned figure in yoga posture with animals around.
- **Terracotta (baked clay) figurines:** mostly female figures, called **mother goddess**; also toy bullock carts, whistles, rattles, animal models and dice.
- **Bronze and stone:** the bronze **Dancing Girl** of Mohenjo-daro (about 10 cm tall) was made by the **lost-wax (cire perdue) method**: a wax model is covered with clay, the wax melts out, and molten bronze fills the mould. The steatite **'Priest-King'** bust from Mohenjo-daro wears a patterned shawl.
- **Beads and jewellery:** carnelian (etched beads), agate, gold, copper, shell and faience (glazed paste) beads; shell bangles; ivory. Bead workshops: **Chanhudaro and Lothal**.



Harappan painted pottery: common designs (schematic redrawing)

5. Trade, weights and script

- **Internal trade:** copper from **Khetri** (Rajasthan), shell and carnelian from Gujarat, and other goods moved by bullock carts and boats.
- **Foreign trade:** with **Mesopotamia** (called **Meluhha** in its texts), also **Dilmun** (Bahrain) and **Magan** (Oman). Lapis lazuli came from Afghanistan (**Shortughai**). Harappan seals and beads have been found in Mesopotamian cities such as Ur. **Lothal** was the port; **Sutkagen-dor** and **Balakot** were coastal outposts.
- **Weights and measures:** cubical chert weights in a ratio of 1 : 2 : 4 : 8 up to 64, then 160, 320 and so on (binary first, then decimal); a bronze/ivory scale was used. Such standards show state control of trade.
- **Script:** pictographic, about 400 signs, mostly written **right to left**; found on seals, pots and the Dholavira signboard. **It is still undeciphered**, so we cannot read Harappan names, laws or history.

6. Religion, burial and society

- **Religion:** no certain temples. Evidence of **mother-goddess** worship, a horned deity (**Pashupati**), **tree** (pipal) and **animal** worship, phallus-like stones (linga), and **fire altars** at Kalibangan and Lothal.
- **Burial:** the dead were usually buried in an extended position with pots and ornaments; cremation and a few double burials (Lothal) are also found. No huge royal tombs.
- **Society and rule:** no palace or royal tomb found, so who ruled is debated (priests, merchants, or a council). Different house sizes show some social difference; the Citadel suggests a ruling group.

7. Why did it decline? (a causes list, not one answer)

There is no single agreed cause. Scholars point to: **change of climate and drying of the Ghaggar–Hakra river**, floods and river shifting, falling trade with Mesopotamia, and breakdown of city control. The old 'Aryan invasion' idea has no evidence of a city-wide massacre and is now largely rejected. After about 1900 BCE people moved east and south into smaller villages (Late Harappan): the cities faded, but the culture did not vanish overnight.

> **EXAM TRAP**
>
> Great Bath: **Mohenjo-daro**; granary: **Harappa**; dockyard: **Lothal**; water system: **Dholavira**; ploughed field: **Kalibangan**; largest in India: **Rakhigarhi**; first post-1947 dig: **Ropar**. Seals are of **steatite**, not iron or gold. No iron, no certain horse, script undeciphered. Do not write 'Mohenjo-daro in India': it is in Pakistan.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Indus Valley Civilization:

1. Dholavira is known for its water-conservation system.

2. Lothal had a dockyard.

3. Kalibangan has evidence of a ploughed field.

4. Iron was widely used by the Harappans.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1, 2 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. It was a Bronze Age civilization; iron was not used, so 4 is wrong.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (feature) with List-II (site):

List-I (feature)	List-II (site)
A. Great Bath	1. Lothal
B. Dockyard	2. Rakhigarhi
C. Ploughed field	3. Mohenjo-daro
D. Largest site in India	4. Kalibangan

(1) A → 3 B → 1 C → 4 D → 2

(2) A → 3 B → 4 C → 1 D → 2

(3) A → 1 B → 3 C → 4 D → 2

(4) A → 3 B → 1 C → 2 D → 4

Answer: (1) Great Bath: Mohenjo-daro; dockyard: Lothal; ploughed field: Kalibangan; largest in India: Rakhigarhi.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about Harappan crafts is NOT correct?

A. Most seals were made of steatite.

B. The 'unicorn' (one-horned bull) is the commonest animal on seals.

C. Fine painted pottery was handmade without a wheel.

D. The bronze Dancing Girl was made by the lost-wax method.

Answer: C. Harappan pottery was wheel-made and kiln-baked, with red slip and black designs such as pipal leaves and fish scales.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): Harappan towns are described as 'planned towns'.
Reason (R): Streets met at right angles, houses used standard burnt bricks and covered drains ran along the streets.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. The grid streets, uniform bricks and drains are exactly what 'planned' means.

PRACTICE

Which of the following are supported by most scholars as causes of the decline of Harappan cities?
1. Drying of the Ghaggar–Hakra river and climate change
2. A mass-killing invasion proved by skeletons in all cities
3. Fall in trade with Mesopotamia
4. River shifting and floods
Select the correct answer:

A. 1, 3 and 4 only

B. 1 and 2 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. No evidence of a city-wide massacre exists; the 'invasion' theory is now largely rejected.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Why is a 'planned town' proof of a strong authority? 2. Name three Harappan crafts with one feature each (pottery, seals, bronze). 3. Write four causes of decline in your own words.

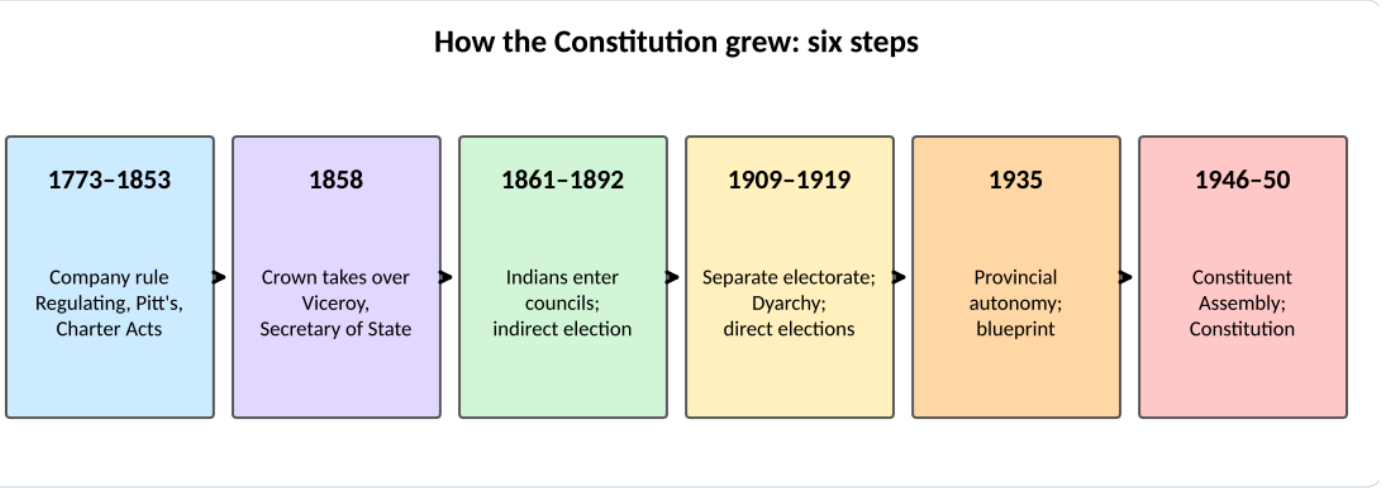
POLITY · Nature of the Indian Constitution and constitutional development

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is a Constitution? It is the supreme rule book of a country. It does three jobs: it creates the organs of government (the legislature that makes laws, the executive that runs them, the judiciary that decides disputes); it **limits** their power so nobody becomes all-powerful; and it gives citizens **rights**. Every ordinary law must agree with it. Think of a cricket match: players change every season, but the rules stay, and the umpire can reject any play that breaks them. **Why it matters:** the Group 2 syllabus begins with this topic, and the rest of Polity (rights, Parliament, courts) all builds on it.

1. How it developed: the story in five steps

Our Constitution did not fall from the sky. Many of its ideas were tried first under British rule. Learn the story, then the years: **Company runs India → Crown takes over → Indians enter the councils → elections begin → provinces get self-rule → independence.**



The six steps of constitutional development

Step	Act (year)	What changed, and why it matters
1. Company rule	Regulating Act 1773	First step to control the Company: Governor of Bengal became Governor-General (Warren Hastings); Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)
	Pitt's India Act 1784	Board of Control: 'double government' of Company and Crown

	Charter Act 1833	Governor-General of **India** (William Bentinck): full centralisation
	Charter Act 1853	Open competition for civil services; legislative work separated from executive
2. Crown rule	Government of India Act 1858	After the 1857 Revolt the Crown took over; Secretary of State for India; Viceroy (Canning)
3. Indians enter councils	Indian Councils Act 1861	Indians nominated to the council; portfolio system; ordinance power
4. Elections begin	Indian Councils Act 1892	Indirect election begins; members may discuss the budget
	Morley–Minto 1909	**Separate electorate** for Muslims (seeds of communal politics); S.P. Sinha first Indian in Viceroy's Executive Council
	Montagu–Chelmsford 1919	**Dyarchy** in provinces; two-house central legislature; direct elections
5. Self-rule	Government of India Act 1935	Provincial autonomy; proposed federation; three lists; Federal Court (1937). **Biggest source of our Constitution.**
6. Independence	Cabinet Mission 1946; Indian Independence Act 1947	Constituent Assembly formed; India independent on 15 Aug 1947; Assembly becomes sovereign

Memory chain: R-P-C-C (1773, 1784, 1833, 1853) = Company years; 1858 = Crown; 61, 92, 1909, 1919 = Indians, elections, separate electorates, dyarchy; 1935 = the blueprint.

2. How the Constitution was made: the Constituent Assembly

A Constituent Assembly is a body elected to write a constitution. Ours was formed under the Cabinet Mission Plan (1946): members were elected **indirectly** by the provincial assemblies (princely states sent nominees). It had 389 planned seats (296 British India + 93 princely states); after Partition about 299 remained.

Event	Fact
First meeting	9 Dec 1946; temporary President **Dr Sachchidananda Sinha**
Permanent President	**Dr Rajendra Prasad** (11 Dec 1946); Constitutional Adviser **B.N. Rau**
Objectives Resolution	Moved by **Nehru** on 13 Dec 1946; adopted 22 Jan 1947; became the **Preamble**
Drafting Committee	Set up 29 Aug 1947; Chairman **Dr B.R. Ambedkar**; 7 members; Draft introduced 4 Nov 1948
Adopted / in force	Adopted **26 Nov 1949** (Constitution Day); in force **26 Jan 1950** (Republic Day)
Time / original size	2 years 11 months 18 days; 395 Articles, 22 Parts, 8 Schedules (now about 450 Articles, 25 Parts, 12 Schedules)

3. What kind of Constitution is it? (its nature)

- **Written and the longest in the world**, because it covers the Centre, States, services, elections and emergency in one document.
- **Federal with a unitary bias** (K.C. Wheare: 'quasi-federal'). Two levels of government and a division of powers (Seventh Schedule), but a strong Centre: single Constitution, single citizenship, Governor appointed by the Centre, emergency powers. Article 1 calls India a '**Union of States**'.
- **Parliamentary system** (British model): real power with the Council of Ministers responsible to the Lok Sabha.
- **Flexible and rigid together:** some parts change by a simple majority, others need a special majority, and a few also need half the States.

EXAMPLE

Example: Why a 'federal with unitary bias' label? If a State Government fails, the Centre can impose President's Rule (Art 356). A pure federation like the USA has no such power. That one rule shows the 'unitary bias'.

EXAM TRAP

Adopted on 26 Nov 1949 but enforced on 26 Jan 1950 (the day was chosen because Purna Swaraj was declared on 26 Jan 1930). The temporary President was Sachchidananda Sinha, not Rajendra Prasad. 'Union of States', not 'Federation', is the wording of Article 1.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:
1. The Regulating Act 1773 created a Supreme Court at Calcutta.
2. The Charter Act 1833 made the Governor-General of Bengal the Governor-General of India.
3. The Indian Councils Act 1892 introduced direct elections.
4. The Government of India Act 1858 ended Company rule.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 4 only

B. 1, 2, 3 and 4

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: A. The 1892 Act began indirect election, not direct. Direct elections came with the 1919 Act.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (Act) with List-II (feature):

List-I (Act)	List-II (feature)
A. Morley–Minto 1909	1. Federal Court
B. Montagu–Chelmsford 1919	2. Separate electorates
C. Government of India Act 1935	3. Dyarchy in provinces
D. Government of India Act 1858	4. Secretary of State for India

(1) A → 2 B → 3 C → 1 D → 4

(2) A → 3 B → 2 C → 1 D → 4

(3) A → 2 B → 3 C → 4 D → 1

(4) A → 1 B → 3 C → 2 D → 4

Answer: (1) 1909: separate electorates; 1919: dyarchy; 1935: Federal Court (1937); 1858: Secretary of State.

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Constituent Assembly:

1. Its members were elected indirectly by the provincial assemblies.

2. Its first meeting on 9 December 1946 was presided over by Sachchidananda Sinha.

3. The Objectives Resolution was moved by Dr B.R. Ambedkar.

4. The Drafting Committee was set up on 29 August 1947.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 4 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. The Objectives Resolution was moved by Jawaharlal Nehru (13 Dec 1946).

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The Constitution of India came into force on 26 November 1949.
Reason (R): 26 January was chosen because Purna Swaraj was declared on 26 January 1930.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: D. It was adopted on 26 Nov 1949 and came into force on 26 Jan 1950. So A is false; R is true.

PRACTICE

A State Government is dismissed by the Centre and President's Rule is imposed in the State under Article 356. Which feature of the Indian Constitution does this best illustrate?

A. Federal structure with a unitary bias

B. Strict separation of powers

C. Independence of the judiciary

D. Universal adult franchise

Answer: A. The Centre's power to take over a State's administration shows the 'unitary bias' of our federal system.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Explain in four lines why the 1935 Act is called the blueprint of our Constitution. 2. Write the five-step story of constitutional development with one year for each step. 3. Why is the Constitution called 'federal with a unitary bias'? Give one example.

REASONING · Number series

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? A number series is a list that follows a hidden rule. Your job is to find the rule and give the next number. The exam gives about 1–2 such questions and each takes under 40 seconds once you know the five common rules. **Method:** (1) look at the gaps between numbers; (2) if gaps are not equal, look at the gaps of the gaps; (3) test multiplication; (4) test squares/cubes; (5) test two interleaved series.

Rule	Example	Answer and why
Add a constant	2, 5, 8, 11, 14, ?	17: each term +3
Multiply by a constant	3, 6, 12, 24, 48, ?	96: each term ×2
Squares / cubes	1, 4, 9, 16, 25, ? and 1, 8, 27, 64, 125, ?	36 (6^2) and 216 (6^3)
Gaps grow	2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?	42: gaps 4, 6, 8, 10, so next gap 12
Multiply then add	3, 7, 15, 31, 63, ?	127: each term ×2 + 1
Two series mixed	5, 10, 8, 16, 14, 28, ?	26: alternately ×2 and −2
Prime numbers	2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, ?	17: next prime

EXAMPLE

Worked example: 7, 10, 16, 28, 52, ? Gaps: 3, 6, 12, 24. The gaps double. Next gap = 48, so the answer is 52 + 48 = **100**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 3, 8, 18, 38, 78, ?

A. 148

B. 156

C. 158

D. 160

Answer: C. Each term = previous × 2 + 2. 78 × 2 + 2 = 158. (The gaps are 5, 10, 20, 40, next gap 80.)

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 2, 12, 36, 80, 150, ?

A. 224

B. 252

C. 262

D. 240

Answer: B. Terms are $n^3 + n^2$: 1+1=2, 8+4=12, 27+9=36, 64+16=80, 125+25=150, so 216+36 = 252.

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 1, 2, 6, 24, 120, ?

A. 600

B. 620

C. 720

D. 840

Answer: C. Multipliers are 2, 3, 4, 5, next is 6. 120 × 6 = 720 (these are factorials).

PRACTICE

Which number is the odd one out? 8, 27, 64, 100, 125, 216

A. 27

B. 64

C. 100

D. 216

Answer: C. All others are perfect cubes (2^3, 3^3, 4^3, 5^3, 6^3). 100 is not a cube.

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 2, 5, 4, 10, 8, 20, 16, ?

A. 32

B. 36

C. 40

D. 44

Answer: C. Two series mixed: positions 1, 3, 5, 7 are 2, 4, 8, 16 (×2); positions 2, 4, 6 are 5, 10, 20 (×2). The next is 20 × 2 = 40.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

> Without looking: write the five rules for number series and one example for each.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 1: write this from memory

Close the notes. In your notebook write the headings below in this order, fill every blank, then open the notes and correct in a different colour.

HISTORY: Indus Valley, Politics · Society · Economy · Religion

Heading	Write these points
Basics	1921 Harappa (Daya Ram Sahni), 1922 Mohenjo-daro (R.D. Banerji), 1924 John Marshall announced. Bronze Age, Mature phase c. 2600–1900 BCE, roots in Mehrgarh. Limits: Sutkagen-dor, Alamgirpur, Manda, Daimabad.
Politics	Planned towns with grid streets, standard bricks and weights show a strong central administration. No palace or temple proved; rulers unknown (priest-kings, merchants or councils are guesses).
Society	Urban: craftsmen, traders, officials, farmers. Houses of different sizes show some inequality. Citadel (west) and lower town (east). Burial of the dead with pots; script undeciphered.
Economy	Farming (wheat, barley, cotton, peas), cattle; crafts (pottery, bronze, beads, seals); trade with Mesopotamia (Meluhha) and weights in ratios of 16; Lothal dockyard.
Religion	Mother goddess figurines, Pashupati seal, sacred trees and animals, fire altars at Kalibangan and Lothal. No temples found.
Decline	Not one cause: river shift/drying, climate change, floods, trade decline. Write 4 causes.

POLITY: Constitutional development (write the chain)

- **Company:** 1773 Regulating, 1784 Pitt's, 1833 Charter (Governor-General of India), 1853 Charter. **Crown:** 1858. **Councils:** 1861, 1892, 1909 (separate electorate), 1919 (dyarchy). **Self-rule:** 1935. **Independence:** 1946 Cabinet Mission, 1947 Act.
- **Assembly:** first meeting 9 Dec 1946 (Sinha), President Rajendra Prasad, Objectives Resolution (Nehru) 13 Dec 1946, Drafting Committee (Ambedkar) 29 Aug 1947, adopted 26 Nov 1949, in force 26 Jan 1950; 2 yrs 11 mo 18 days; 395 Articles, 22 Parts, 8 Schedules.
- **Nature:** written and longest; federal with unitary bias (Art 1 'Union of States'); parliamentary; flexible and rigid.

REASONING: Number series

Write the 7 rules with one example each: add a constant, multiply by a constant, squares/cubes, growing gaps, multiply then add, two series mixed, primes. Method: gaps → gaps of gaps → ×, → squares/cubes.